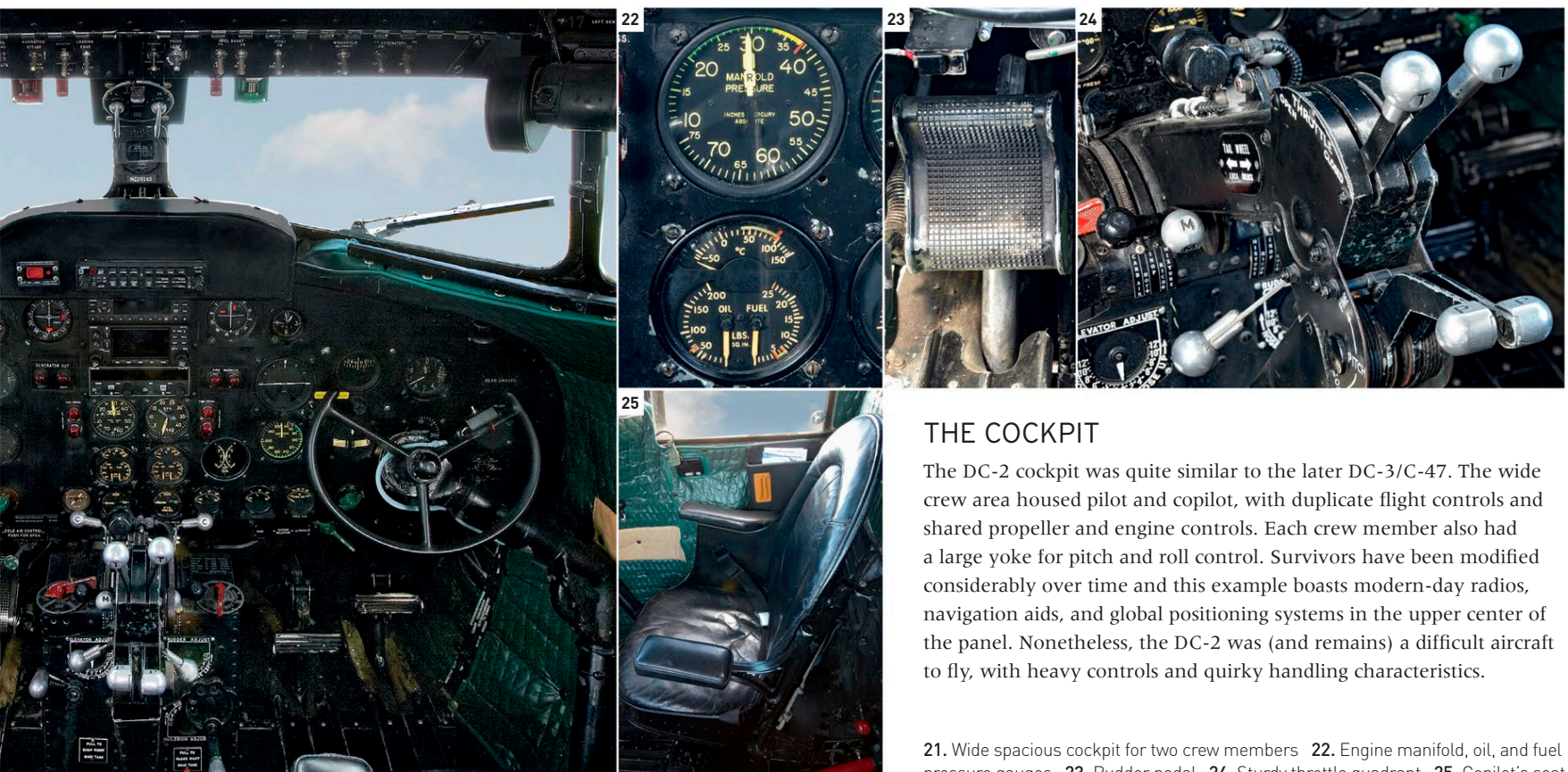


THE INTERIOR

The DC-2 offered vastly improved comfort compared to primitive airliners, such as the Ford Tri-motor. Passengers were seated in sturdy seats and the cabin was lined with soundproofing fabrics in an attempt to make the flying experience as pleasant as possible in an era when flights from Newark to Los Angeles took 18 hours. However, American Airlines wanted an aircraft with a greater level of comfort to replace their Curtiss Condors, so commissioned Douglas to produce the Douglas Sleeper Transport (DST) variant with sleeping berths for 14 passengers. This would later form the basis for the DC-3.

14. An in-flight lavatory was a luxury in the 1930s 15. Warning placards are a modern health and safety addition 16. Hat racks above the cabin seats 17. Modern-day upholstery has replaced the original seat coverings in this preserved aircraft 18. Lever to adjust reclining position on chair 19. Lifejackets were located beneath each seat 20. Curtains around the window of an emergency exit helped add an element of luxury



THE COCKPIT

The DC-2 cockpit was quite similar to the later DC-3/C-47. The wide crew area housed pilot and copilot, with duplicate flight controls and shared propeller and engine controls. Each crew member also had a large yoke for pitch and roll control. Survivors have been modified considerably over time and this example boasts modern-day radios, navigation aids, and global positioning systems in the upper center of the panel. Nonetheless, the DC-2 was (and remains) a difficult aircraft to fly, with heavy controls and quirky handling characteristics.

21. Wide spacious cockpit for two crew members 22. Engine manifold, oil, and fuel pressure gauges 23. Rudder pedal 24. Sturdy throttle quadrant 25. Copilot's seat